

Current Events





About the Course

Students are exposed to current events by reading from a variety of sources and having age-appropriate conversations with teachers. Topics such as scientific discoveries, the arts, and human interest stories are generally suitable.

This topic is included in the following course(s): Citizenship: Grade 5, Citizenship: Grade 6, Citizenship: Grade 7 (U.S.), Citizenship: Grade 7 (Canada), Citizenship: Grade 8 (U.S.), Citizenship: Grade 8 (Canada)



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
5-8	Current Events: Grades 5-8 1+ time/week 15 min	

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Citizenship: Grade 5				
Community Read Alouds: Grades 1-12	Current Events: Grades 5-8			Plutarch: Beginner Track
Citizenship: Grade 6				
	Plutarch: Grades 6-8	Community Read Alouds: Grades 1-12		Current Events: Grades 5-8
Citizenship: Grade 7 (U.S.)				
Ethics: Part 1 Community Read Alouds: Grades 1-12		American Government: Grade 7		Plutarch: Grades 6-8 Current Events: Grades 5-8
Citizenship: Grade 7 (Canada)				
Ethics: Part 1 Community Read Alouds: Grades 1-12		Canadian Government: Grade 7		Plutarch: Grades 6-8 Current Events: Grades 5-8
Citizenship: Grade 8 (U.S.)				
Ethics: Part 2 Community Read Alouds: Grades 1-12		American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 Current Events: Grades 5-8		Plutarch: Grades 6-8
Citizenship: Grade 8 (Canada)				
Ethics: Part 2 Community Read Alouds: Grades 1-12		Canadian Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 Current Events: Grades 5-8		Plutarch: Grades 6-8



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the

time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

Citizenship: Grade 7 (U.S.)

☐ Make sure your student sets up a Citizenship Notebook. They will need a 3-ring binder, lined notebook paper, and 5 Tabbed Dividers. You can read more about how to set one up and suggestions for various sections in the document in Quick Links.

☐ As desired, plan for a read aloud time. Suggestions are provided in the Community Read Aloud Quick Link, but local favorites are highly recommended whenever possible.

☐ Make a Calendar of Events for Current Events lessons by drawing a calendar grid in a notebook (or print a blank calendar from the internet).

Citizenship: Grade 7 (Canada)

☐ Make sure your student sets up a Citizenship Notebook. They will need a 3-ring binder, lined notebook paper, and 5 Tabbed Dividers. You can read more about how to set one up and suggestions for various sections in the document in Quick Links.

☐ As desired, plan for a read aloud time. Suggestions are provided in the Community Read Aloud Quick Link, but local favorites are highly recommended whenever possible.

☐ Make a Calendar of Events for Current Events lessons by drawing a calendar grid in a notebook (or print a blank calendar from the internet).

Citizenship: Grade 8 (U.S.)

☐ Make sure your student sets up a Citizenship Notebook. They will need a 3-ring binder, lined notebook paper, and 5 Tabbed Dividers. You can read more about how to set one up and suggestions for various sections in the document in Quick Links.

☐ As desired, plan for a read aloud time. Suggestions are provided in the Community Read Aloud Quick Link, but local favorites are highly recommended whenever possible.

☐ Make a Calendar of Events for Current Events lessons by drawing a calendar grid in a notebook (or print a blank calendar from the internet).

Citizenship: Grade 8 (Canada)

☐ Make sure your student sets up a Citizenship Notebook. They will need a 3-ring binder, lined notebook paper, and 5 Tabbed Dividers. You can read more about how to set one up and suggestions for various sections in the document in Quick Links.

☐ As desired, plan for a read aloud time. Suggestions are provided in the Community Read Aloud Quick Link, but local favorites are highly recommended whenever possible.

☐ Make a Calendar of Events for Current Events lessons by drawing a calendar grid in a notebook (or print a blank calendar from the internet).

Citizenship: Grade 5

☐ Make sure your student sets up a Citizenship Notebook. They will need a 3-ring binder, lined notebook paper, and 5 Tabbed Dividers. You can read more about how to set one up and suggestions for various sections in the document in Quick Links.

☐ As desired, plan for a read aloud time. Suggestions are provided in the Community Read Aloud Quick Link, but local favorites are highly recommended whenever possible.

☐ Make a Calendar of Events for Current Events lessons by drawing a calendar grid in a notebook (or print a blank calendar from the internet).

Citizenship: Grade 6

☐ Make sure your student sets up a Citizenship Notebook. They will need a 3-ring binder, lined notebook paper, and 5 Tabbed Dividers. You can read more about how to set one up and suggestions for various sections in the document in Quick Links.

☐ As desired, plan for a read aloud time. Suggestions are provided in the Community Read Aloud

Quick Link, but local favorites are highly recommended whenever possible.

☐ Make a Calendar of Events for Current Events lessons by drawing a calendar grid in a notebook (or print a blank calendar from the internet).



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

Current Events: Grades 5-8

- ∞ [The Pour Over | Subscribe](#)
- ∞ [The World and Everything In It](#)
- ∞ [World Watch \(Paid Subscription Required\)](#)
- ∞ [The Sift](#)
- ∞ [BBC](#)
- ∞ [Teaching Kids News \(CA\)](#)
- ∞ [1Jour1Actu \(in French\)](#)

[Click THIS text
or scan the QR
code for links.](#)



Current Events: Grades 5-8

How To Teach



Prepare

Plutarch: Teachers will find it helpful to preread the entire *Life* first, and then preread the day's passage before each lesson. Mark any passages that should be omitted due to content. (In Anne White's Plutarch Project books, the recommended source for this course, objectionable content has already been omitted.)

Current Events: Preview the news source for suitability.

Most other citizenship topics don't require additional prep.



Recap

Connect back to the previous lesson. (Optional for Current Events).



Introduce

For news sources, show students how to scan the headlines to get an overview first and then choose a story to read.

For Plutarch or other books: Use a picture, a map, or an engaging question to prepare students to receive the story as relevant. You may talk about one or two unfamiliar words that will be crucial to understanding. It is not necessary to cover all unfamiliar words.



Read

Read the selection assigned or the news story chosen. For rich, dense, or more challenging books such as *Ourselves* and Plutarch, it is a good idea to read them aloud. Have students keep an eye out for things to add to their Citizenship Notebook, *Book of Centuries*, and/or *Commonplace* book.



Narrate

Have the students narrate orally or in writing.



Discuss

Give students an opportunity to share their thoughts on the story and any connections made. For current events, look up where events occurred on a map and ask questions to help students discern the quality of the piece. (e.g., Are there sources cited? Is there an obvious bias? If so, what do other authors have to say on this subject? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?) Consider reading an alternative perspective.



Citizenship Notebook

Have students record important ideas in their Citizenship Notebooks.

Current Events: Grades 5-8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 1 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Tracker

Tracker: ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you?
Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 2 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Tracker

Tracker: ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

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→ LOCATE

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→ NOTEBOOK

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WEEK 3 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Tracker

Tracker: ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

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Term 1

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

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Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 4 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Tracker

Tracker:    

News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

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→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

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→ NOTEBOOK

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WEEK 5 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Tracker

Tracker:    

News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

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Look at a map and find where the events occurred



Term 1

	→ NOTEBOOK Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.	
WEEK 6	15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Tracker Tracker: ☐☐☐☐☐☐ News source of your choice PREP: Preview news source → INTRO Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news). → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS News story • What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible? → LOCATE Look at a map and find where the events occurred → NOTEBOOK Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.	
WEEK 7	15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Tracker Tracker: ☐☐☐☐☐☐ News source of your choice PREP: Preview news source → INTRO Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news). → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS News story • What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible? → LOCATE Look at a map and find where the events occurred → NOTEBOOK Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.	
WEEK 8	15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Tracker Tracker: ☐☐☐☐☐☐ News source of your choice PREP: Preview news source	

Current Events: Grades 5-8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

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→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

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→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 9 ☐ 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Tracker

Tracker: ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

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News story

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 10 ☐ 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Tracker

Tracker: ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

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Term 1	
→ LOCATE Look at a map and find where the events occurred → NOTEBOOK Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.	
WEEK 11 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Tracker Tracker: News source of your choice PREP: Preview news source → INTRO Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news). → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS News story • What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible? → LOCATE Look at a map and find where the events occurred → NOTEBOOK Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.	
WEEK 12 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Tracker Exam Week → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course.	

Current Events: Grades 5-8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

WEEK 1 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Tracker

Tracker: ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

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→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

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Look at a map and find where the events occurred

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WEEK 2 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Tracker

Tracker: ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

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WEEK 3 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Tracker

Tracker: ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you?
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Term 2

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

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Look at a map and find where the events occurred

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Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 4 ☐ 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Tracker

Tracker: ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

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→ NOTEBOOK

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WEEK 5 ☐ 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Tracker

Tracker: ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

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- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

Current Events: Grades 5-8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 6 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Tracker

Tracker: ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

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→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

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Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 7 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Tracker

Tracker: ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

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News story

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→ LOCATE

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→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 8 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Tracker

Tracker: ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

Current Events: Grades 5-8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 9 ☐ 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Tracker

Tracker: ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

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News story

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 10 ☐ 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Tracker

Tracker: ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

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→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

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Term 2

- LOCATE
Look at a map and find where the events occurred
- NOTEBOOK
Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 11 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Tracker
Tracker:

- News source of your choice
PREP: Preview news source
- INTRO
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 - READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS
News story
 - What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?
 - LOCATE
Look at a map and find where the events occurred
 - NOTEBOOK
Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 12 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Tracker
Exam Week

- EXAMS
Answer question(s) related to course.

Current Events: Grades 5-8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 1 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Tracker

Tracker: ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you?

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News story

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→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 2 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Tracker

Tracker: ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

News source of your choice

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WEEK 3 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Tracker

Tracker: ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

News source of your choice

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Term 3

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 4 ☐ 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Tracker

Tracker: ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

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→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

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WEEK 5 ☐ 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Tracker

Tracker: ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

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→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

Current Events: Grades 5-8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 6 □ 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Tracker

Tracker: □ □ □ □ □

News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 7 □ 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Tracker

Tracker: □ □ □ □ □

News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

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→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 8 □ 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Tracker

Tracker: □ □ □ □ □

News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source



Term 3

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you?
Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 9 ☐ 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Tracker

Tracker: ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

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Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 10 ☐ 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Tracker

Tracker: ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

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Term 3

- LOCATE
Look at a map and find where the events occurred
- NOTEBOOK
Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 11 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Tracker
Tracker:

- News source of your choice
PREP: Preview news source
- INTRO
Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).
 - READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS
News story
 - What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?
 - LOCATE
Look at a map and find where the events occurred
 - NOTEBOOK
Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 12 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Tracker
Exam Week

- EXAMS
Answer question(s) related to course.

Current Events: Grades 5-8

Examination

Term 1 · Tell the story of one of the news events of this term.

Term 2 · Tell the story of one of the news events of this term.

Term 3 · Tell the story of one of the news events of this term.